



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times



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CLOCKWISE from top left, Morgan State University’s “Magnificent Marching Machine” band plays; crowds stay dry(ish); and performers join Kermit the Frog on the “Visit Mississippi” float at the 137th Rose Parade.

Even rainy skies can’t damp excitement at Rose Parade

By ITZEL LUNA, IRIS KWOK, CHRISTOPHER BUCHANAN AND HAILEY BRANSON-POTTS

As a steady rain pounded Colorado Boulevard in Pasadena before dawn Thursday, Michael Brooks hunched beneath a daisy-printed umbrella, guarding his family’s front-row seats for the 137th Rose Parade.

The 41-year-old Monterey Park resident clasped a cup of hot chocolate. Despite the deluge, he smiled from his lawn chair.

It was his first time attending the Rose Parade in person, he said. Why wouldn’t he be happy?

“I was not going to miss this opportunity,” Brooks said. “I had to be right here, front row, for my mother-in-

law, for my wife, for my kids.”

Cue the jokes about raining on everyone’s parade, because this year’s Rose Parade was the first wet one in two decades.

It was just the 11th rainy Rose Parade since the event — meant to show off Southern California’s mild winters — began in 1890.

By 10 a.m. Thursday, just as the parade was wrapping up on the 5.5-mile route, the storm had dumped 1.21 inches of rain on eastern Pasadena over 12 hours, according to the National Weather Service in Oxnard. Downtown Los Angeles had received 1.33 inches.

Hardcore parade fans camped overnight along the route, huddling beneath awnings and raincoats as they rang in the new year. They included Tracy Tankersley, who welcomed 2026 by guarding 15 lawn chairs on Colorado Boulevard all night.

For her, the parade was essentially a family reunion. Tankersley drove from San Diego on Wednesday with her son and son-in-law to join her mother on the route. Her other son, his wife, and their five children came from Colorado.

Tankersley held out hope for dry skies, despite the

forecasts. When rain threatened in years past, the sun always came out just in time. This year, though, “it proved me wrong,” she said.

When she and her family camp, they’re usually surrounded by spectators packing the route, lying on mattresses, swapping stories around fire pits. This year, Tankersley spent the frigid night alone, dozing off briefly while the rest of her family snoozed in nearby vehicles.

She said it “was a different Rose,” but still an experience to remember.

Once the floats started [See **Rose Parade**, A4]

SWEEPSTAKES AWARD: A float built by Cal Poly students takes top honors in the 137th Rose Parade. **A5**



JEAN-CHRISTOPHE BOTT Keystone

SWISS police gather outside the site of the blaze.

Dozens killed in fire at Swiss Alps resort

By JAMEY KEATEN, STEFANIE KAZIO AND JOHN LEICESTER

CRANS-MONTANA, Switzerland — About 40 people were killed and 115 others injured, most of them seriously, after a fire ripped through a New Year’s celebration in a Swiss Alpine resort bar less than two hours after midnight Thursday, police said.

Authorities did not immediately have an exact count of the dead.

The Crans-Montana resort is best known as an international ski and golf venue, and overnight, its crowded Le Constellation bar morphed from a scene of revelry into the site of one of Switzerland’s worst tragedies. The country will ob-

serve five days of mourning.

Valais Canton police commander Frédéric Gisler said it was too early to determine that work is underway to identify the victims and inform their families, adding that the community is “devastated.”

Thirteen of the wounded were Italian citizens, and six more Italians remained unaccounted for, Italy’s ambassador to Switzerland, Gian Lorenzo Cornado, told state-run RAI television.

Beatrice Pilloud, Valais Canton’s attorney general, said it was too early to determine the cause of the fire. Experts have not yet been able to go inside the wrecked age.

“At no moment is there a question of any kind of attack,” Pilloud said. [See **Switzerland**, A3]

Suit alleges abuse of female inmates at L.A. County jail

Women at Lynwood lockup say male deputies grope them, watch them shower.

By CONNOR SHEETS

A federal lawsuit filed on behalf of dozens of current and former inmates in Los Angeles County’s women’s jail claims male correctional officers watched them shower, harassed and groped them and retaliated when the alleged abuses were reported.

The suit accuses deputies of taking advantage of women incarcerated at Century Regional Detention Facility in Lynwood.

The case comes amid renewed scrutiny of how the Sheriff’s Department handles abuse claims. Records reviewed by The Times show that jail inmates have made nearly 600 allegations of sexual abuse or harassment against staff since 2021, but none have been referred to the L.A. County district attorney’s office for prosecution.

Brian Dunn, managing partner and lead civil rights attorney with the Cochran Firm, which brought the case on behalf of 38 women

in late October, said in an interview that dozens of inmates shared “chilling” allegations of “brazen” sexual abuse and harassment.

“It seemed to be happening with such frequency that it was like a practice. ... This is something that has been accepted,” he said. “It’s heartbreaking for me to hear these women crying and the only thing you can do is sue.”

The Sheriff’s Department said in a statement that, after learning about Dunn’s lawsuit, it “initiated a review of the claims to ensure that all appropriate investigative and administrative processes were followed.”

“The safety, dignity, and constitutional rights of every individual in our custody remain our top priority,” the department added. “We are committed to transparent operations, thorough investigations, and maintaining the highest standards of professional conduct.”

The civil complaint filed in the Central District of California says abuses occurred in the Lynwood jail’s administrative segregation unit, also known as “the hole.” The lawsuit claims women were often sent there for disciplinary purposes — and that deputies would watch [See **Lawsuit**, A7]

It took pressure to reveal errors in Palisades fire

A year later, questions swirl about firefighting decisions — and about disclosures afterward.

By PAUL PRINGLE AND ALENE TCHEKMEDYAN

Pacific Palisades had been burning for less than two hours when word raced through the ranks of the Los Angeles Fire Department that the agency’s leaders had failed to pre-deploy any extra engines and crews to the area, despite warnings of life-threatening winds.

In the days after the fire broke out, and as thousands of homes and businesses continued to go up in flames, then-Fire Chief Kristin Crowley said little about the lack of pre-deployment, which was first disclosed by The Times, instead blaming those high winds, along with a shortage of working engines and money, for her agency’s failure to quickly knock down the blaze.

Crowley’s comments did not stand up to scrutiny. To several former LAFD chief officers as well as to people who lost everything in the disaster, her focus on equipment and City Hall finances marked the beginning of an ongoing campaign of secrecy and deflection by the department — all designed to avoid taking full responsibility for what went wrong in the preparations for and response to the Jan. 7 fire, which killed 12 people and

leveled much of the Palisades and surrounding areas.

“I don’t think they’ve acknowledged that they’ve made mistakes yet, and that’s really a problem,” said Sue Pascoe, editor of the local publication Circling the News, who lost her home of 30 years. “They’re still trying to cover up. ... It’s not the regular firefighters. It’s coming from higher up.”

With the first anniversary of the fire a week away, questions about firefighting missteps remained largely unanswered by the LAFD and Mayor Karen Bass. Among them: Why were crews ordered to leave the still-smoldering scar of an earlier blaze that would reignite into the Palisades inferno? Why did the LAFD alter its after-action report on the fire in a way that appeared intended to shield it from criticism?

The city also has yet to release the mayor’s communications about the after-action report. The Times requested the communications in November, and the report — which was meant to pinpoint failures and enumerate lessons learned, to avoid repeating mistakes — was issued in early October. Nor has the city fulfilled a records request from The Times about the whereabouts of fire engines in the Palisades when the first 911 call came in. It took the first crews about 20 minutes to reach the scene, by which time the fierce winds were [See **Fire**, A8]

Immigration raids linked to job losses

A UC Merced study used census data to track private-sector changes over months.

By SUHAUNA HUSSAIN

Each month, Edward Flores crunches the numbers. And each month he grows more and more certain of the stark effect of federal immigration raids on California’s economy.

Flores found that the number of people reporting private-sector employment in California in late May and early June fell by 3.1% — a drop so significant it was exceeded in recent memory only by the employment downturn during the COVID-19 pandemic lockdown.

The associate professor of sociology and faculty director of the UC Merced labor center based his analysis on U.S. census data from those months and published his findings over the summer.

Flores has repeated the

analysis for each month since June, with the exception of October, when the federal government shut down and for the first time in some 50 years did not collect the data.

The decline in employment grew, with a 4.9% decrease in the first week of July — 742,492 fewer workers.

Numbers somewhat bounced back in August, after a U.S. district judge temporarily banned roving patrols of immigration agents from stopping people based on the color of their skin, language spoken or vocation. But from May to September, private-sector employment fell by 2.9%, Flores said in his latest report.

“We are seeing a pretty persistent trend,” Flores said. “It really underscores the urgency with which our elected officials and policymakers should be devising ways of mitigating the economic harm that is occurring as a result of immigration enforcement actions.”

The analysis shows an outsized effect on noncitizen [See **Raids**, A1f]

Hidden dangers on Mt. Baldy

Wintry conditions can make for a dangerous climb, hikers warn after the recovery of three bodies. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

EV firm aims for top affordability

Slate, working in L.A. and Detroit areas, hopes to have a \$25,000 base model on the market this year. **BUSINESS, A10**

Weather

Cloudy, a shower. L.A. Basin: 69/58. **B6**

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GINA FERRAZZI Los Angeles Times

OMAR COOPER JR. hauls in a touchdown.

Indiana rolls over Alabama

The Hoosiers’ defense thoroughly throttles the Crimson Tide in a 38-3 victory at the 112th Rose Bowl. **SPORTS, B10**